**Perseverant Digital**
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A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL · FOR HOME IMPROVEMENT

# The Seminar Seat-to-Client Playbook

Plan an educational seminar or webinar that fills seats, gets registrants to actually show up, and turns the people in the room into booked consultations.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 60 WORDS

REVIEWED OCTOBER 15, 2026

Educational seminars and webinars still work when the decision is large and the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone. Pick a topic phrased as the question your audience already has, promote two to three weeks out, send reminders by email and consented text, teach without pressure, and call every attendee within 72 hours to book the next conversation.

## Is an event right for your business?

An event is worth the effort when the decision is large, the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone, and you have someone who can teach in plain language. People are not only searching to find you; they are searching to understand you. A good event lets them do that in an hour.

- [ ] Buyers hesitate for weeks or months because the decision costs or matters a lot.
- [ ] You have a presenter who explains clearly and does not oversell.
- [ ] You can name one next step, such as a consultation, a home assessment or a tour.
- [ ] Someone can call every attendee within a day or two.

All four checked means an event is worth a trial. Otherwise, fix the gaps first.

## What this looks like for home improvement companies

Storm, solar and remodel seminars work when they answer a real cost question. Homeowners make these purchases rarely and want to understand them before anyone comes to quote.

Harvard's Joint Center for Housing Studies projected on April 15, 2026 that owner-occupied improvement and repair spending would grow only about 1.6% to 2.1%, to $518 billion by Q4 2026. Slow growth means homeowners compare carefully. A contractor who teaches the buying process gives them a reason to call that one first.

Explain how storm claims work without promising approval. Walk remodel audiences through scope, permits, timeline and comparing bids. Hold events at your showroom or a community room in your service area, and make the next step a free home assessment, booked before another estimator is in the driveway.

## What topic will actually fill seats?

Phrase the topic as the question your audience already asks, not as your service name. A title that names their worry fills seats. Rewrite these in the words your clients use on the phone.

| Trade | Topic phrased as the audience's question |
|---|---|
| Roofing | What a roof insurance claim really involves after a storm |
| Solar | How to read a solar quote: total cost, financing and tax credits |
| Remodeling | What a kitchen remodel costs and how long it takes |
| HVAC | Replacing your heating and cooling system: how to compare quotes |
| Remodeling | Aging in place: home changes worth making before you need them |

| Question my clients ask most | Who asks it | Could I teach it in 45 minutes? (Y/N) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Should it be in person, a webinar or both?

Go in person when trust is the main barrier and the audience is local. Go webinar when the audience is spread out or busy. Choose hybrid only if you can staff two rooms at once.

| Factor | In person | Webinar | Hybrid |
|---|---|---|---|
| Builds trust | Fastest | Moderate | Strong in the room only |
| Cost per attendee | Higher | Lower | Highest to run well |
| Biggest risk | Empty seats you paid for | Low live attendance | Neither audience gets full attention |

Judge any format by cost per booked consultation, not cost per registration.

## What does the 21-day timeline look like?

Promote two to three weeks out, as ON24, an enterprise webinar platform, advised on November 26, 2025. ON24 also advises reminders one week, one day and 15 minutes before; we add a confirmation and a morning-of message for local events.

| Day | Task | Done |
|---|---|---|
| −28 | Pick topic, date, venue or platform, and presenter | [ ] |
| −24 | Build the registration page (checklist below) and confirmation email with a calendar link | [ ] |
| −21 | Test reminders end to end; launch ads, email your list, send partners a blurb to forward | [ ] |
| −14 | Second email; review cost per registration and cut what is not working | [ ] |
| −7 | One-week reminder (email, text optional) with one thing they will learn | [ ] |
| −3 | Rehearse; confirm room, tech and staff | [ ] |
| −1 | One-day reminder (email and text) with time, place or link, parking or tech note | [ ] |
| 0 | Morning-of and 15-minute texts with the address or link; run the event | [ ] |
| +1 to +3 | 72-hour follow-up (below) | [ ] |

Registration page checklist:

- [ ] Headline that repeats the topic question, with date, time and place above the form
- [ ] Three bullets on what attendees will learn, and a short factual presenter bio
- [ ] Form: name, email, phone, and an unchecked text-consent box that says they can reply STOP
- [ ] A plain line that the event is educational and nobody will be pressured

## How many registrations do you actually need?

Work backward from the seats you want filled.

Seats wanted ÷ show rate = registrations needed Registrations needed ÷ page conversion rate = clicks needed Clicks needed × cost per click = estimated ad budget

**Example numbers, not benchmarks.** For 30 people in the room at a 50% show rate, you need 60 registrations. At 15% page conversion, that is 400 clicks. At $2.50 per click, about $1,000 in ads.

For context, ON24 reported a 60% average registrant-to-attendee rate in its 2025 data (June 19, 2026). That is a vendor figure drawn mostly from B2B enterprise webinars, not a target.

| Line | Your number |
|---|---|
| Seats wanted | |
| Expected show rate | |
| Registrations needed | |
| Page conversion rate | |
| Clicks needed | |
| Cost per click | |
| Estimated ad budget | |
| Consultations booked | |
| Ad budget ÷ consultations booked | |

Run the last line after every event. It tells you whether to keep going.

## What should happen during and after the event?

Teach first and name one next step. Answer the title question in the first ten minutes, leave 15 minutes for questions, and explain exactly what happens in the consultation, assessment or tour. End with a feedback card or poll: “Would you like someone to call you?” yes or no.

Then move fast. In Harvard Business Review research on online leads (March 2011), firms that contacted leads within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify them as firms that waited longer. Attendees are warmer than web leads, but the clock still applies.

| When | Attendees | Registered no-shows |
|---|---|---|
| Same day | Thank-you email with a summary and booking link | Replay or next date |
| Day 1 | Call everyone who said yes on the card | Text (with consent) offering the replay |
| Day 2 | Call remaining attendees once | Second email with one key point |
| Day 3 | Email anyone not reached with a booking link | Invite to the next event |

Track each attendee in one list: attended, wants a call, called, booked, became a client.

## What compliance items apply?

Check these before launch. This is general information, not legal advice.

- **Solar disclosures.** The FTC (August 7, 2024) expects total cost and financing terms disclosed, no overstated savings or tax credits, and no “free solar” language.
- **No outcome promises.** Do not promise a claim will be approved or a project will save a set amount.
- **Texting.** The TCPA still requires prior express written consent for autodialed marketing texts. Since April 11, 2025, people can revoke by any reasonable means, such as replying STOP, and opt-outs must be honored within 10 business days (Kelley Drye; Burr & Forman).
- **Email.** CAN-SPAM covers B2B email too: accurate headers, a postal address and opt-outs honored within 10 business days (FTC). Bulk Gmail senders also need SPF, DKIM and DMARC (Google, February 1, 2024).

## Where do most owners get stuck?

> **Filling seats at a sane cost.** The first event shows your real cost per registration. Lowering it takes testing topics, audiences and creative across several events before the money runs out.

> **Reminder automation across email and text.** A sequence that pulls from your form, respects text consent, honors STOP and stops for cancellations takes systems work most teams do not have time for.

> **Booking assessments before someone else does.** Attendees often invite several companies to quote. Getting on the calendar first means calling the next morning, with an estimator schedule that can absorb a busy week.

If any of these sound familiar, a 25-minute exploration call can help you sort out the next step. Use the short form at the end of this guide.

## Sources


- ON24, “Key Takeaways From the Webinar Benchmarks Report,” June 19, 2026. link
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- Burr & Forman, “The FCC Delays Effective Date of TCPA Revoke-All Rule Until January 31, 2027,” accessed October 15, 2026. link
- Federal Trade Commission, “CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business,” accessed October 15, 2026. link
- Google, “Email Sender Guidelines,” February 1, 2024. link
- Harvard Joint Center for Housing Studies, “Remodeling Growth Set to Downshift in Late 2026,” April 15, 2026. link
- Federal Trade Commission, “Don’t Waste Your Energy: Solar Scam,” August 7, 2024. link

## Want a second set of eyes on what you found?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your answers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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